

SENATE RESOLUTION 297

By Yager

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Sister Carrie Elizabeth Rowan Barksdale of Harriman.

WHEREAS, we were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of Sister Carrie Elizabeth Rowan Barksdale of Harriman; and

WHEREAS, Carrie Barksdale was an exemplary public servant and consummate professional who worked assiduously to improve the quality of life for her fellow citizens in numerous capacities; and

WHEREAS, born on June 16, 1927, Mrs. Barksdale was the daughter of Blanche Rowan and Charlie Murdock and attended Campbell High School in Rockwood; and

WHEREAS, throughout her professional career, Mrs. Barksdale demonstrated dedication and perseverance through her work at the Federal Bakery Shop, the Tennessee School of Beauty, and the Oak Ridge Racquet, as well as in private homes in Oak Ridge; and

WHEREAS, a woman of many talents and interests, Mrs. Barksdale was blessed to travel throughout the country and across the world, enriching her life with both meaningful experiences and cultural discovery; in particular, her journey to Jerusalem deeply touched her heart and spirit, marking it as one of the most emotional and sacred moments of her life; and

WHEREAS, Carrie Barksdale was wholly devoted to her faith and an active member of Sevier Drive Church of Christ, where she served in several capacities throughout the years; her vision and obedience to God led her to establish Ladies Inspiration Day fifty-one years ago, an enduring ministry that has uplifted women and churches in Tennessee and Georgia; and

WHEREAS, no stranger to awards and accolades, Carrie Barksdale received the Key to the City of Harriman in 1998 from Mayor Harold Wester and again from current Mayor Wayne Best; she was honored by the Highway 27 Church of Christ in Summerville, Georgia, for her

contributions to Ladies Inspiration Day, and she was the recipient of the Pioneer Christian Award and the Hard Fighting Soldier Award; and

WHEREAS, in addition to being named a Golden Treasure by Roane County, Mrs. Barksdale was honored at the fortieth annual Ladies Inspiration Day at the Sevier Drive Church of Christ in 2015 for her loyalty and selfless service; she received tributes from Governor Bill Haslam, Harriman City Mayor Chris Mason, and Senator Ken Yager for her influence and lifelong commitment to her faith and her community; and

WHEREAS, Carrie Barksdale was a leader in her community and served the Tennessee State Youth Conference as a counselor, the Knoxville Track Club as a treasurer, the Roane County Choral Society as a soprano singer, and the former Harriman Hospital as a volunteer and Pink Lady; she was also a representative for the March of Dimes and served as a board member of Keep Roane Beautiful; and

WHEREAS, Carrie Barksdale was deeply devoted to her family, and she always endeavored to remain true to family values of the highest order; and

WHEREAS, she will be sadly missed but fondly remembered by her daughters, Darlene (Charles) Johnson, Marcia McMahan, Trellis Barksdale, and Sharrieffa Barksdale; her special cousins, Alice Pettus and Ennis Sumrell; and a host of nieces, nephews, grandchildren, great-grandchildren, great-great-grandchildren, cousins, and friends; and

WHEREAS, in addition to her parents, Mrs. Barksdale was preceded in death by her husband, Marcellus Barksdale; her half-brother, Charles William Kimbrough; her half-sister, Dee Stafford; her daughters, Eleece Barksdale McCleskey and Phadra Barksdale Hanks; her son, Val Barksdale; her sons-in-law, Gary McMahan and Tommy McCleskey; and her grandson, Albert Marcellus Hanks; and

WHEREAS, Mrs. Barksdale lived her life with purpose, faith, humility, and joy, and she greatly impacted the lives of those who were blessed to know her; her life was a testimony of perseverance, kindness, and unwavering devotion to God, her family, and her community; and

WHEREAS, she leaves behind an indelible legacy of integrity and probity in public life, compassion and loyalty in private life, and diligence and dedication in all her chosen endeavors; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this legislative body should pause to remember the bountiful life of this exceptional public servant and human being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, that we hereby honor the memory of Sister Carrie Elizabeth Rowan Barksdale, reflecting fondly upon her impeccable character and her stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we express our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family and friends of Mrs. Barksdale.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy.